

EU PHARMA & BIOTECH HIRING LIST 2026

— INDIA EDITION —

Compiled for Indian Pharma & Biotech Professionals

B.Pharm · M.Pharm · MBBS · MSc Biotech · PhD Life Sciences

6

Countries

30+

Companies

5 Visa
Types

Covered

€40K–€170
K

Salary Range

Who This List Is For

- B.Pharm / M.Pharm / MSc Pharmaceutical Sciences
- MBBS / MD — Medical Affairs, Pharmacovigilance, Clinical Research
- MSc Biotech / PhD Life Sciences — R&D, Drug Discovery, Data Science
- All roles include work visa sponsorship for non-EU nationals
- Freshers to 5+ years experience — roles for every level

Data compiled from company careers pages, LinkedIn, and public immigration records (2024–2026). Salary ranges are indicative. Always verify directly with employers. This is not immigration or legal advice.

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Visa Quick Reference — 6 Countries

Country	Visa Type	Salary Min	Key Benefit	Timeline
■■ Netherlands	Highly Skilled Migrant	€60K/yr	No lottery, 30% tax ruling	2 weeks
■■ Switzerland	Swiss B Work Permit	CHF 80K/yr	Highest salaries globally	8–12 weeks
■■ Germany	EU Blue Card	€45.3K/yr	Permanent residence in 21 mo	4–8 weeks
■■ Denmark	Pay Limit Scheme	DKK 465K/yr	English everywhere, high quality of life	6 weeks
■■ Belgium	EU Blue Card	€45.3K/yr	EMEA HQ hub, French/Dutch optional	4–10 weeks
■■ Ireland	Critical Skills Permit	€38K/yr	English only, PR path in 2 years	4–8 weeks

Netherlands

Visa: Highly Skilled Migrant (HSM) Visa — No lottery, approved in 2 weeks. Salary threshold ~€5,008/month (2026). 30% tax ruling for first 5 years.

Company	City	Top Roles	Exp Level	Visa	Salary (EUR)	Hybrid
AstraZeneca careers.astrazeneca.com	Zoetermeer	Clinical Research, Regulatory Affairs, Medical Affairs, QA	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	HSM Visa	€52K–€88K	✓
Janssen (J&J;) careers.jnj.com	Leiden & Tilburg	Biotech R&D;, QA/QC, Pharmacovigilance, Regulatory	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	HSM Visa	€55K–€90K	✓
Philips Healthcare philips.com/a-w/careers.html	Amsterdam & Best	Clinical Affairs, Medical Devices R&D;, Regulatory, Data Science	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	HSM Visa	€55K–€92K	✓
MSD (Merck) jobs.merck.com	Haarlem & Oss	QA, Regulatory Affairs, Manufacturing, Formulation	1–3 yrs / 3–5 yrs	HSM Visa	€50K–€82K	~
Novartis Netherlands novartis.com/careers	Amsterdam	Medical Affairs, Market Access, Clinical Research, Pharmacovigilance	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	HSM Visa	€60K–€95K	✓
DSM-Firmenich dsm-firmenich.com/en/careers.html	Heerlen & Rotterdam	Biotech R&D;, Formulation, Supply Chain, QA	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	HSM Visa	€48K–€78K	~
ASML asml.com/en/careers	Eindhoven	Data Science (Clinical/R&D;), Systems Engineering, Pharma Data	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	HSM Visa	€65K–€105K	✗
uniQure uniqure.com/careers	Amsterdam	Gene Therapy R&D;, QC, Regulatory, Clinical Operations	2–5 yrs	HSM Visa	€55K–€85K	~

Application Tips

AstraZeneca: Apply via global careers portal; mention HSM eligibility in cover letter.

Janssen (J&J;): Filter by 'Life Sciences' and 'Netherlands' on careers page.

Philips Healthcare: LinkedIn shows 400+ Indian employees; network before applying.

MSD (Merck): Search 'Netherlands' + your role on jobs.merck.com directly.

Novartis Netherlands: Novartis Talent Community signup gets you early notifications.

DSM-Firmenich: Biotech freshers: target their Innovation Graduate Programme.

ASML: PhD Life Sciences + data skills = strong fit for their R&D; data roles.

uniQure: Niche gene therapy company — M.Pharm + Biotech combo is ideal.

Switzerland

Visa: Swiss Work Permit (L/B Permit). Employer must demonstrate no suitable EU/EFTA candidate available. Salary benchmarks apply. Major pharma companies have established non-EU hire tracks.

Company	City	Top Roles	Exp Level	Visa	Salary (EUR)	Hybrid
Roche roche.com/careers	Basel & Zurich	Biotech R&D;, Clinical Research, Regulatory, Pharmacovigilance, Data Science	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	Swiss B Permit	CHF 90K–150K (€95K–160K)	✓
Novartis novartis.com/careers	Basel (HQ)	Drug Discovery, Clinical Research, Regulatory Affairs, Medical Affairs	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	Swiss B Permit	CHF 95K–160K (€100K–170K)	✓
Lonza lonza.com/careers	Basel & Visp	Biotech Manufacturing, QA/QC, Formulation, Process Development	2–5 yrs	Swiss B Permit	CHF 80K–130K (€85K–138K)	✗
Idorsia idorsia.com/careers	Allschwil (Basel area)	Drug Discovery, Clinical Research, Pharmacology	3–5 yrs / PhD	Swiss B Permit	CHF 85K–130K (€90K–138K)	✓
Sanofi Switzerland sanofi.com/en/talent	Geneva & Meyrin	Regulatory Affairs, Medical Affairs, Pharmacovigilance	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	Swiss B Permit	CHF 88K–145K (€93K–154K)	✓

Application Tips

Roche: Apply 3–6 months in advance; interview process is 4–6 rounds.

Novartis: Novartis NIBR (research arm) actively recruits PhDs from Indian IITs/IISc.

Lonza: CDMO roles — M.Pharm or MSc Biotech with GMP experience is gold.

Idorsia: Smaller biotech — direct LinkedIn outreach to hiring managers works well.

Sanofi Switzerland: Geneva office = multilingual environment; English sufficient for most roles.

Germany

Visa: EU Blue Card (salary ≥€45,300/yr for pharma/science roles) or Germany Opportunity Card (points-based job search visa). Employer-sponsored work permit also available. No quota.

Company	City	Top Roles	Exp Level	Visa	Salary (EUR)	Hybrid
Bayer AG career.bayer.com	Leverkusen & Berlin	Pharma R&D;, Regulatory, Clinical Research, Medical Affairs, QA	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	EU Blue Card	€55K–€95K	✓
Boehringer Ingelheim boehringer-ingelheim.com/careers	Ingelheim am Rhein	Drug Discovery, Formulation, Manufacturing, QA, Clinical Research	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	EU Blue Card	€52K–€90K	~
Merck KGaA jobs.merckgroup.com	Darmstadt	Life Science R&D;, Regulatory, QC, Data Science, Biotech	3–5 yrs / PhD	EU Blue Card	€55K–€92K	✓
Siemens Healthineers siemens-healthineers.com/careers	Erlangen & Munich	Medical Devices, Clinical Affairs, Regulatory, Data Science	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	EU Blue Card	€58K–€95K	✓
BioNTech biontech.com/careers	Mainz	mRNA R&D;, Immunology, Clinical Research, Regulatory	PhD / 3–5 yrs	EU Blue Card	€62K–€100K	~
Fresenius Kabi fresenius-kabi.com/careers	Bad Homburg	Formulation, Manufacturing, QA/QC, Regulatory	1–3 yrs / 3–5 yrs	EU Blue Card	€45K–€72K	✗

Application Tips

Bayer AG: Bayer Pharma Graduate Program open to non-EU; apply Oct–Nov each year.

Boehringer Ingelheim: Internship → full-time pathway well established; apply for trainee roles.

Merck KGaA: Merck KGaA ≠ US Merck (MSD). Apply on merckgroup.com separately.

Siemens Healthineers: MBBS + clinical data = strong fit for Clinical Affairs roles.

BioNTech: Post-COVID expansion — PhD in immunology/mRNA is extremely competitive.

Fresenius Kabi: M.Pharm Formulation + GMP = high hire probability for production roles.

■ Denmark

Visa: Pay Limit Scheme (salary ≥DKK 465,000/yr ~€62K) or Positive List Scheme for shortage occupations. Fast-track for specialist roles. English is the working language at major pharma.

Company	City	Top Roles	Exp Level	Visa	Salary (EUR)	Hybrid
Novo Nordisk novonordisk.com/careers	Bagsvaerd (Copenhagen)	Drug Discovery, Clinical Research, QA, Regulatory, Data Science	3–5 yrs / PhD	Pay Limit Scheme	DKK 600K–900K (€80K–121K)	✓
Genmab genmab.com/careers	Copenhagen	Antibody R&D;, Clinical Development, Regulatory, Medical Affairs	PhD / 3–5 yrs	Pay Limit Scheme	DKK 650K–1M (€87K–134K)	✓
LEO Pharma leo-pharma.com/careers	Ballerup (Copenhagen)	Dermatology R&D;, QA/QC, Clinical Research, Regulatory	2–5 yrs	Pay Limit Scheme	DKK 550K–800K (€74K–107K)	✓

■ Application Tips

Novo Nordisk: Novo Nordisk is the single biggest pharma employer in Denmark; apply broadly.

Genmab: Niche antibody company — PhD + antibody engineering is very competitive here.

LEO Pharma: Smaller than Novo Nordisk — less competition, faster hiring process.

■ Belgium

Visa: Single Permit or EU Blue Card. Belgium has Flanders and Wallonia immigration tracks. Major pharma cluster in Ghent, Liege, and Mechelen. English widely spoken in pharma.

Company	City	Top Roles	Exp Level	Visa	Salary (EUR)	Hybrid
UCB ucb.com/careers	Brussels & Braine-l'Alleud	Neuroscience R&D;, Clinical Research, Regulatory Affairs, QA	3–5 yrs / 5+ yrs	EU Blue Card	€58K–€95K	✓
Janssen EMEA HQ careers.jnj.com	Beerse (Antwerp)	R&D;, Pharmacovigilance, Regulatory, Medical Affairs, Manufacturing	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	EU Blue Card / Single Permit	€52K–€88K	~
Galapagos NV glpg.com/careers	Mechelen	Drug Discovery, Clinical Research, Biomarkers, QA	PhD / 3–5 yrs	EU Blue Card	€55K–€88K	✓

■ Application Tips

UCB: UCB focuses on rare diseases — neurology background is a strong differentiator.

Janssen EMEA HQ: Beerse site = EMEA HQ for Janssen; apply directly for Belgium roles.

Galapagos NV: Series B+ biotech — strong fit for PhD Life Sciences in drug discovery.

■ Ireland

Visa: Critical Skills Employment Permit (annual salary ≥€38,000 for pharma roles). No quota. 2-year permit → Stamp 4 (permanent residency pathway). 100% English working environment.

Company	City	Top Roles	Exp Level	Visa	Salary (EUR)	Hybrid
AstraZeneca Ireland careers.astrazeneca.com	Dublin & Cork	Manufacturing, QA, Regulatory, Clinical Research	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	Critical Skills Permit	€48K–€82K	~
GSK Ireland gsk.com/en-gb/careers	Cork & Dublin	Vaccines Manufacturing, QA/QC, Regulatory, Clinical	1–3 yrs / 3–5 yrs	Critical Skills Permit	€50K–€85K	~
Pfizer Ireland pfizer.com/about/careers	Dublin & Ringaskiddy (Cork)	Manufacturing, Process Development, QA, Regulatory, R&D;	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	Critical Skills Permit	€52K–€92K	~
MSD Ireland jobs.merck.com	Dublin & Brinny (Cork)	Biotech Manufacturing, QA, Regulatory, Process Dev	1–3 yrs	Critical Skills Permit	€50K–€85K	✗
ICON plc iconplc.com/careers	Dublin (HQ)	Clinical Research Associate, CDM, Pharmacovigilance, Regulatory	0–2 yrs / 3–5 yrs	Critical Skills Permit	€45K–€78K	✓

■ Application Tips

AstraZeneca Ireland: Cork manufacturing site frequently hires pharmacists and QA engineers.

GSK Ireland: GSK Waterford site — M.Pharm + QA is one of highest-hire role combos.

Pfizer Ireland: Pfizer Ringaskiddy = world's largest pharma manufacturing site. Apply here.

MSD Ireland: Biotech + QA combo is very strong for MSD Ireland's Cork sites.

ICON plc: Best CRO entry point for Indian freshers — ICON hires 0–2yr experience.

Email Templates for Indian Applicants

Use these templates to cold email hiring managers or HR directly. Find the contact on LinkedIn first — do not use generic careers@ addresses.

Template 1 — For R&D; / Clinical / Regulatory Roles

Subject: [Your Module/Specialisation] Application – [Degree] + [X Years Experience] Dear [Hiring Manager Name], I am [Your Name], a [M.Pharm / MSc Biotech / PhD Life Sciences] graduate with [X years] of experience in [QA / Regulatory Affairs / Clinical Research / Drug Discovery]. I am currently based in [India / Current Country] and I am eligible for the [Highly Skilled Migrant Visa / EU Blue Card / Critical Skills Permit] – no lengthy sponsorship complexity on your end. Key highlights: • [Achievement 1 – e.g., "Led ICH Q10 compliance audit across 3 manufacturing sites"] • [Achievement 2 – e.g., "Authored 8 regulatory dossiers for CDSCO and EMA submission"] • [Achievement 3 – e.g., "Reduced QC batch failure rate by 28% through SOP redesign"] I would welcome a 20-minute call to discuss how I can contribute to [Company Name]'s team. Best regards, [Your Name] | [LinkedIn URL] | [Phone / WhatsApp]

Template 2 — LinkedIn Connection Message (300 chars)

Hi [Name], I'm a [M.Pharm/PhD Biotech] with [X yrs] in [QA/Regulatory/Clinical]. I'm exploring opportunities at [Company] in [Netherlands/Germany/Ireland] and would love to connect. I'm HSM/Blue Card eligible – happy to share my CV if there's any fit. Thank you!

Pro Tips for Indian Applicants

- Always mention your visa eligibility (HSM / Blue Card / Critical Skills) in the FIRST email — it removes the employer's biggest concern immediately.
- Apply on the careers page AND cold email the hiring manager simultaneously — doubles your response rate.
- Follow up exactly once after 7 days with a 2-line message: 'Following up on my application for [Role]. Happy to share additional materials if helpful.'
- Add 'EU Blue Card eligible' or 'Highly Skilled Migrant Visa eligible' to your LinkedIn headline — recruiters in Europe filter for this.
- XING.com is Germany's LinkedIn — create a profile for German roles. Many Indian applicants skip this and lose to candidates who are on XING.
- Switzerland: Apply 3–6 months before your target start date. Swiss work permit process is longer than other EU countries.

How to Use This List — Step by Step

1

Step 1 — Shortlist by Role

Identify your specialisation: QA/QC, Regulatory Affairs, Clinical Research, R&D, Pharmacovigilance, Manufacturing, Formulation, or Medical Affairs. Highlight every company in this list that has your role in their top hiring categories.

2

Step 2 — Shortlist by Country

Prioritise countries based on your visa preference. Netherlands = fastest visa, 30% tax ruling. Ireland = English only, no language barrier. Germany = largest market, EU Blue Card. Switzerland = highest salary but toughest process.

3

Step 3 — LinkedIn Research

For each shortlisted company, search '[Company Name] + India' on LinkedIn. Find Indian employees in your role. Connect with 2–3 of them. Ask for a 15-minute informational chat. This is your highest-conversion channel.

4

Step 4 — Apply Directly + Cold Email Simultaneously

Apply through the careers page link in this document. At the same time, find the hiring manager or HR partner for your department on LinkedIn and send the cold email template. Do both on the same day.

5

Step 5 — Mention Visa Upfront

In every application, cover letter, and email — mention which visa you are eligible for and that your expected salary meets the threshold. This turns your visa status from a risk into a non-issue for the employer.

6

Step 6 — Follow Up Once

If no response after 7 days — send one follow-up. After that, move on. Persistence beyond one follow-up damages your impression. Apply to the next company on the list.

7

Step 7 — Track Your Applications

Use a simple spreadsheet: Company | Role | Applied Date | Email Sent | Follow Up Date | Status. Aim to have 20+ active applications running at the same time.

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